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WRITING EFFECTIVE FUNCTIONS



Functions are like mini programs within our programs that allow us to break code into smaller units. This spares us from having to write duplicate code, which can introduce bugs. But writing effective functions requires making many decisions about naming, size, parameters, and complexity.

This chapter explores the different ways we can write functions and the benefits and drawbacks of different trade-offs. We'll delve into how to trade off between small and large functions, how the number of parameters affects the function's complexity, and how to write functions with variable numbers of arguments using the `*` and `**` operators. We'll also explore the functional programming paradigm and the benefits of writing functions according to this paradigm.

Function Names

Function names should follow the same convention we use for identifiers in general, as described in Chapter 4. But they should usually include a verb, because functions typically perform some action. You might also include a